

Community Learning Pilot — 2025 Project Report

Final Evaluation and Impact Summary for the Riverdale Neighborhood Pilot Initiative

1. Executive Summary

During the 2025 calendar year, BrightPath Community Initiative implemented the 'Community Learning Pilot' (CLP) in the Riverdale municipal area. The pilot aimed to test an after-school tutoring model focused on elementary school reading literacy and basic digital exposure for students from low-income households.

Over the 11-month operating period, **the 2025 pilot served 640 students** across three municipal partner sites. Participants received structured academic assistance, participated in small-group reading circles, and utilized supervised computer stations to complete school assignments. The pilot achieved an overall program retention rate of 82%, with strong parental satisfaction and observable academic progress.

2. Geographic Scope and Participant Profile

The CLP initiative operated across three neighborhood clusters within the Riverdale municipality: Central Riverdale, Oakwood Terrace, and North Riverdale. A total of **640 unique students** registered and participated in at least 15 hours of programming.

Demographic Metric	Pilot Metric / Breakdown	Context / Notes
Total Unduplicated Students Served	640 students	Tracked via unique student registry ID numbers
Grade Distribution	Grade 1–3: 42% Grade 4–5: 36% Grade 6–8: 22%	Elementary concentration across Title I schools
Household Income Threshold	74% qualifying for free/reduced lunch subsidy	Verified during annual intake registration
English Language Learners (ELL)	38% of participating student cohort	Bilingual tutors deployed for support
Average Attendance per Student	3.4 hours / week over 28 active weeks	Total aggregate student hours: 61,200 hrs

3. Program Activities Conducted

BrightPath Community Initiative delivered three primary operational intervention streams throughout the 2025 pilot:

- **Structured Literacy Interventions:** Daily 45-minute reading circles led by trained literacy tutors focusing on vocabulary expansion, phonics, and guided reading comprehension for students reading below grade level.
- **Homework Assistance Labs:** Supervised afternoon homework completion support, providing quiet study spaces, reference materials, and individual assistance from collegiate volunteers.
- **Introductory Digital Literacy:** Weekly sessions introducing basic touch typing, internet navigation safety, and basic educational software usage on shared laptops.

4. Evaluation Results and Academic Outcomes

A formal evaluation was conducted at the conclusion of the pilot using pre- and post-program assessments, teacher feedback surveys, and parent evaluations. Key findings include:

Evaluation Domain	Measurement Instrument	Key Outcome / Result
Reading Comprehension	Standardized Grade-Level Diagnostic	71% of regularly attending participants demonstrated a full grade-level improvement in reading fluency.
Homework Completion Rate	Teacher Academic Survey (N=48)	84% of classroom teachers reported marked improvements in on-time homework submission among participants.
Digital Confidence	Pre- and Post-Lab Skills Matrix	88% of participating students achieved mastery of core digital productivity tasks (word processing, search navigation).
Parental Satisfaction	End-of-Year Survey (N=210)	93% of parents reported that the pilot significantly reduced household academic stress and improved student motivation.

5. Lessons Learned and Operational Challenges

While the 2025 pilot achieved commendable success, several critical operational insights emerged:

- 1. Venue Stability & Facilities:** Relying on temporary municipal community rooms caused scheduling conflicts during civic elections and public meetings. Future initiatives require dedicated, memorandum facility partnerships (such as local schools or permanent centers).
- 2. Hardware-to-Student Ratio:** With only 10 laptops shared among 640 participants on a rotating schedule, digital literacy workshops experienced equipment bottlenecks. Expanding laptop availability to at least 20 dedicated devices is essential.
- 3. Standardized Data Collection:** While qualitative feedback was robust, collecting longitudinal report cards from the public school district proved administratively burdensome without a formal school collaboration agreement.

6. Recommendations for 2027 Expansion

Based on the empirical findings of the 2025 CLP, BrightPath recommends transitioning from temporary pop-up learning spaces to fully institutionalized 'Community Learning Hubs' in direct partnership with local schools and established community facilities.

Securing philanthropic grant funding in the \$70,000–\$75,000 range will enable dedicated coordinator staffing, 20 new laptops, and formalized academic tracking, expanding the proven model to serve hundreds of additional underserved students annually.

Report Prepared By:

Dr. Aris Thorne
Dr. Aris Thorne, Lead Evaluator
Riverdale Educational Consulting Group

Approved By:

Elena Rostova
Elena Rostova, Executive Director
BrightPath Community Initiative